

7.2.2 ZoneAlarm

A Comparison With SPF

Despite Sygate's claims of SPF being the easiest-to-use personal firewall, we do think that with its cleaner interface and fewer options, ZoneAlarm is easier to use. The fewer options does not mean that your computer is less protected; however, you do feel less 'in control.' The position that ZoneAlarm takes is that most people just want their systems protected from all the baddies out there, and that they don't want to configure anything.

ZoneAlarm assumes you know much less about firewalls than SPF does.

Before we tell you something about the program, remember that this version—the one provided on the DVD—is free *only* for personal and non-profit use.

Our Experience

The installer asks you to configure the firewall and choose between the basic and Pro versions. After installation, you're invited to watch a video (this requires you to be connected to the Internet) that teaches you how ZoneAlarm protects you, important tips and shortcuts for using the program, and about the situations when you may need to take action.



ZoneAlarm provides you most of the information you need to know in an easy screen, without going into technicalities. The emphasis is on ease of use

The first thing we saw was the program detecting our anti-virus trying to access the Internet, and presenting a pop-up win-